

8.3. Closing files:

Consider you have opened a file and have worked on it. Now you want to close the file as an open file may disturb the server by capturing the resources and causing unwanted turbulence. PHP has functions for both opening and closing files.

It offers an easy method of closing a file. Even if you forget to close file that is open, the server automatically closes all files when the PHP execution is completed. It is a good practice to close all files once you are done.

PHP provides the `fclose()` function to close file that is open. The `fclose()` function requires the file handle to close it. Once a file is closed using the `fclose()` function, it cannot be read, written into or further appended. You can reopen the file with the same `fopen()` function.

Look at the example:

```
1.      <?php
$file_name = fopen("XYZ.txt","r");
//some code to be executed
fclose ($file_name);
?>

2.      $ourFileName = "testFile.txt";
$ourFileHandle = fopen($ourFileName, 'w') or
die("can't open file");
fclose($ourFileHandle);
```

While closing a file, it is necessary to check, if the file has reached its end. The following syntax supports this argument:

The `feof()` function checks if the “end-of-file” (EOF) has been reached.